NUCAMPUS360 · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Project charter

The agreement on what NuCampus360 set out to do in one weekend and what comes after the hackathon.

PROJECT
NuCampus360

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

PROJECT
NuCampus360, an AI virtual campus tour guide for incoming students CONFIRMED

EVENT
Emerald Forge Hackathon, March 2026 CONFIRMED

MY ROLE
UI/UX design and user research CONFIRMED

TOOLS
Figma and an AI chatbot CONFIRMED

RESULT
Did not win; strong feedback from industry professionals CONFIRMED

CAMPUS
Northeastern University, Seattle TO CONFIRM

Purpose

Incoming students decide on a campus they have never walked. A brochure or a flat video does not answer the questions they actually have. NuCampus360 lets a student explore real campus locations in 360 degrees, see them on a map, and ask an AI guide the questions a map cannot answer. CONFIRMED

Objectives

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE	TARGET	BASIS
1	Find out what visitors really want to know, on site	Campus locations visited for research	8 in one weekend	CONFIRMED Met
2	Design a tour built around those needs	Figma flows and screens approved by the team	Complete before build starts	CONFIRMED Met
3	Demo a working prototype at the hackathon	Prototype with 360 views, map, location details and Ask AI	Shown at final judging	CONFIRMED Met

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE	TARGET	BASIS
4	Get honest outside feedback	Feedback from industry professionals	Collected	CONFIRMED Met
5	Test the idea with incoming students after the event	Student sessions completed	8 sessions	PROPOSED
6	Decide whether to pilot with an admissions office	Pilot conversation held	1 office	PROPOSED

Deliverables

- Research notes from 8 campus locations CONFIRMED
- Figma flows and screens CONFIRMED
- Interactive prototype with 360 views of the lobby, classrooms, dining area, study spaces, lounge and Flex Lab, each with a campus map, location details and an Ask AI button CONFIRMED
- A 4-minute walkthrough video CONFIRMED
- Hackathon pitch CONFIRMED

Roles

WHO	ROLE	BASIS
Aditi Kela	UI/UX design and user research	CONFIRMED
Hackathon team	Build and pitch the prototype from the shared Figma design	CONFIRMED team existed; roles TO CONFIRM
Industry professionals (judges and mentors)	Gave feedback after the pitch	CONFIRMED
Incoming students	Target users and the source of questions	CONFIRMED

Timeline: the hackathon weekend

The event ran one weekend. The hour blocks are my reconstruction of how the work was sequenced, so please correct them. TO CONFIRM

WHEN	ACTIVITY	OUTPUT	BASIS
Friday evening	Kickoff, team and problem choice	One problem statement	ESTIMATE
Saturday morning	Research at 8 campus locations	Observations and questions from visitors	CONFIRMED research happened; timing ESTIMATE
Saturday midday	Synthesis and user needs	Short list of questions the tour must answer	ESTIMATE
Saturday afternoon	Flows and screens in Figma	One agreed picture for the team	CONFIRMED Figma first; timing ESTIMATE
Saturday night to Sunday morning	Build prototype, capture 360 views, set up chatbot	Working prototype	ESTIMATE
Sunday midday	Demo video and pitch rehearsal	4-minute walkthrough, pitch	ESTIMATE
Sunday afternoon	Final pitch and feedback	Feedback from professionals	CONFIRMED

After the hackathon (proposed)

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	DURATION	BASIS
1. Validate	8 student sessions with the prototype and a short survey	2 weeks	PROPOSED
2. Tighten	Fix the top issues, trim the 4-minute video to 90 seconds, add location content	3 weeks	PROPOSED
3. Pilot pitch	Meet the admissions team, show the gap, agree on a trial	2 weeks	PROPOSED
4. Pilot	Run the tour for one intake cycle, track questions and inquiries	8 weeks	PROPOSED

Risks

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
The prototype was built in a weekend and may break at scale	High	Medium	Treat it as a prototype; rebuild the data layer before a pilot
Chatbot gives a wrong answer about the campus	Medium	High	Restrict answers to approved campus content and show "ask admissions" when unsure
Photos of people or private spaces	Medium	Medium	Capture spaces when empty and get permission for each location
The university already contracts a tour vendor	Medium	Medium	Position as a supplement for the Seattle campus, where no 360 tour was found
No buyer	Medium	High	Talk to admissions before building more

Assumptions

- The research method was conversation on site rather than a formal survey. CONFIRMED at a high level; details TO CONFIRM
- Next-phase dates are proposals. PROPOSED

Approval

NAME	ROLE	VERSION	DATE
Aditi Kela	UI/UX design and user research	1.0, draft for review	October 15, 2026

Scope statement

The edge of the project, for the hackathon prototype and for a pilot.

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Scope in one paragraph

NuCampus360 is a virtual tour of campus locations in 360 degrees. Each location shows a campus map, details and an Ask AI button. The chatbot answers the questions a map cannot. CONFIRMED

In scope: hackathon prototype

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	STATUS	BASIS
R1	360-degree views of the lobby, classrooms, dining area, study spaces, lounge and Flex Lab	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
R2	Campus map paired with each view	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
R3	Location details for each place	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
R4	Ask AI button that opens the chatbot	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
R5	Walkthrough video of the prototype	Should	Built (4 minutes)	CONFIRMED
R6	Design in Figma before build	Must	Done	CONFIRMED

In scope: pilot (proposed)

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	BASIS
P1	Chatbot answers only from approved campus content	Must	PROPOSED
P2	Fallback to an admissions contact when the chatbot is unsure	Must	PROPOSED
P3	Usage analytics: views per location, questions asked, drop-off	Must	PROPOSED
P4	Accessible layout and text alternatives for each 360 view	Should	PROPOSED
P5	Short 90-second intro tour	Should	PROPOSED

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY	BASIS
P6	Additional locations beyond the first six	Could	PROPOSED

Out of scope

- Applications, enrollment or payment PROPOSED
- Live human chat PROPOSED
- VR headset experience PROPOSED
- Indoor navigation and wayfinding PROPOSED
- Other campuses until Seattle is validated PROPOSED

Acceptance criteria

- Each location opens its 360 view, map position, details and Ask AI button in under 3 seconds on a normal connection. PROPOSED
- Ten test questions drawn from the research all get a correct answer or a safe handoff. PROPOSED
- A first-time visitor finds a dining area view without help. PROPOSED

Assumptions and constraints

- One weekend for the prototype; the pilot is a separate decision. CONFIRMED
- 360 content must be captured on site, with permission. PROPOSED
- Chatbot answers depend on content provided by campus staff. PROPOSED

Change control

1. Write the change and the reason.
2. Check it against the research question it serves.
3. Score it with MoSCoW.
4. Add it only if it is a Must or replaces something of the same size.
5. Record the decision.

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User research summary and template

Documents the on-site research and gives templates for recording what visitors said and for the follow-up round.

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> The detailed notes from the 8 locations are yours. This document records what was done and gives you a place to add what you heard. No findings are invented here. TO CONFIRM

What was done

- Research was run at 8 campus locations in a single weekend. CONFIRMED
- The research came before the design. The team designed from what people said on site, not from assumptions. CONFIRMED
- The product choices that followed: explore locations interactively, and add a chatbot for questions a map cannot answer. CONFIRMED

Research questions the work served

#	QUESTION	DESIGN DECISION IT INFORMS
RQ1	What do incoming students want to know about a campus before they arrive?	Which locations and details to show
RQ2	Which questions do maps and brochures fail to answer?	What the chatbot must handle
RQ3	What do they look at first when they enter a space?	Order and framing of each 360 view
RQ4	What do visitors find confusing about the campus today?	Map labels and location details

These questions are my reconstruction of what the research needed to answer. Edit them to match what you asked. TO CONFIRM

Capture template for on-site conversations

LOCATION	TIME	WHO (ROLE ONLY)	WHAT THEY WERE TRYING TO DO	QUESTION THEY ASKED OR HAD	WHAT WAS HARD OR CONFUSING	QUOTE

The eight locations (add)

#	LOCATION	NOTES	TOP QUESTION HEARD
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Synthesis steps

1. Put each observation on its own note with its location.
2. Group notes by theme: orientation, food, study, social, support, logistics.
3. Count how many locations raised each theme.
4. Rank themes by how many locations raised them and how serious the problem was.
5. Convert the top themes into chatbot test questions and location details.

Follow-up validation plan (proposed)

ITEM	PLAN
Participants	8 incoming or recently admitted students, a mix of international and domestic
Method	20-minute session: 5 minutes on expectations, 10 minutes on the prototype, 5 minutes on questions and trust
Tasks	Find the dining area, find a quiet study space, ask a question about the campus, say what is missing
Measures	Time to complete each task; number of questions answered correctly; ease rating 1 to 5; would they share the tour (yes/no)
Consent	Explain purpose, recording, and that nothing identifying is stored
Decision	Continue to pilot if at least 6 of 8 complete all tasks and say the tour helped them

> The pass mark in the last row is a proposal. PROPOSED

Interview guide for the follow-up (20 minutes)

TIME	PROMPTS
0:00	"Tell me how you decided on this campus." "What did you wish you had seen before arriving?"
0:05	Give the prototype. "Find the dining area." "Find a place to study quietly." Ask them to think aloud.
0:15	"Ask the guide something you wondered about." "Did the answer help? Did you trust it?"
0:18	"What is missing?" "Would you send this to a friend who is deciding?"

Findings log (complete after synthesis)

THEME	LOCATIONS OR PARTICIPANTS	EVIDENCE	INSIGHT	CHANGE

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Ideation and prioritization

How the idea was shaped in one weekend, and how to rank what to build next.

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Problem statement

Incoming students must choose a campus they have never walked. Brochures and flat videos do not answer the questions they actually have. How might a virtual tour let them explore real places and get answers to their own questions? CONFIRMED

How might we

- HMW let students see the places they will actually use, not the postcard views?
- HMW answer small questions about the campus at any hour?
- HMW show where a place is as well as what it looks like?
- HMW help staff learn what students ask most?
- HMW keep answers correct when the campus changes?

Ideas considered

THEME	IDEA	STATUS
Explore	360 views of lobby, classrooms, dining area, study spaces, lounge, Flex Lab	Built CONFIRMED
Orient	Campus map beside every view; location details	Built CONFIRMED
Ask	Ask AI button at each location	Built CONFIRMED
Reach	90-second intro; language options; accessible text	PROPOSED
Insight	Analytics for admissions on common questions	PROPOSED
Extend	Indoor navigation; event-day tours; VR	PROPOSED later

Prioritization (RICE)

Reach is visitors per year for the first campus, Impact 0.5 to 3, Confidence a percentage, Effort person-weeks. The analytics dashboard serves one buyer, so its reach is 1. All numbers are my proposals. PROPOSED

RANK	IDEA	REACH	IMPACT	CONFIDENCE	EFFORT	RICE SCORE
1	Ask AI button on every location	6,000	2.0	80%	2	4,800.0
2	Chatbot limited to approved campus content	6,000	3.0	70%	4	3,150.0
3	90-second intro tour	6,000	1.5	70%	2	3,150.0
4	360 views of the most asked-about spaces	6,000	2.5	80%	4	3,000.0
5	Seasonal updates (winter, orientation week)	6,000	1.0	50%	3	1,000.0
6	Language options for international students	3,000	2.0	50%	5	600.0
7	Indoor navigation	2,000	1.5	30%	10	90.0
8	Question analytics dashboard for admissions	1	3.0	60%	4	0.4

MoSCoW

MUST	SHOULD	COULD	WILL NOT (PILOT)
Approved-content chatbot	90-second intro	Language options	Indoor navigation
360 views of core spaces	Analytics dashboard	Seasonal updates	VR headset mode
Map and details with each view	Accessible text alternatives	Additional locations	Live human chat

Decisions made at the hackathon

DECISION	REASON	BASIS
Go to the campus to research	Short on time; the campus was the fastest source of truth	CONFIRMED
Explore locations interactively	A flat video does not answer real questions	CONFIRMED
Add a chatbot	For the questions a map cannot answer	CONFIRMED
Design in Figma first	Team builds from one agreed picture	CONFIRMED

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Competitive analysis

Who sells virtual tours and AI enrollment chat to universities, and what is missing for a Seattle student.

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> Research accessed October 15, 2026. Customer counts and result percentages below are vendor claims, not verified. Pricing was not published by any vendor. SOURCED

Vendors

VENDOR	WHAT IT DOES	360 OR MAP	CHATBOT OR AI	ANALYTICS	PRICING
YouVisit (EAB)	Virtual tour and experiential content platform	360 panoramas, aerial imagery, clickable layers. Map not found as a feature	Conversational inquiry form; chatbot not found	Portal described as "45+ insights" (vendor)	Not found; request a demo
Concept3D	360 and map-based tours for campuses and venues	Interactive maps, indoor 3D mapping, 360 panoramas, category-filtered maps	Not found	Not found	Not found; one reviewer said it "is not cheap"
CampusReel	Student-made video content and embeddable tours	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found; demo offered
Mainstay (formerly AdmitHub)	AI and text messaging for admissions	Not found	Chatbots by SMS, web chat and social; AI knowledge base	Not detailed	Custom plans; not published
Ocelot	AI student engagement for enrollment and retention	Not found	AI virtual assistant, two-way texting, live human assistant	Not found on the vendor page	Not found

Northeastern Seattle today

ITEM	WHAT WAS FOUND	SOURCE
Virtual tour	No 360 or video virtual tour found on the Seattle campus pages	seattle.northeastern.edu/the-seattle-campus/
Interactive map	None found; pages list two addresses only	seattle.northeastern.edu/the-seattle-campus/about-the-campus/
Student Campus Guide	A PDF from about October 2022 with study spaces by floor, laptop loans, transit and emergency steps. No maps or hours	seattle.northeastern.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/3/2022/12/Student-Campus-Guide_Dec-2022.pdf
Live offers	Booked tours and appointments; free monthly Zoom sessions called Seattle Virtual Campus Connect	enroll.northeastern.edu/portal/campusconnect?tab=F._Seattle; connect.northeastern.edu/portal/seattle_virtual_campus_connect
Boston and Oakland	Undergraduate admissions links an interactive YouVisit tour; Seattle is not mentioned	admissions.northeastern.edu/visit/virtual-visit-experience/

> Northeastern's own pages disagree on the Seattle tour address (225 Terry Ave N versus 401 Terry Ave N #103). I did not open the YouVisit tour itself, so its features are unknown. SOURCED

Gap and opportunity

- Tour vendors sell 360 content but none of the vendor pages read showed an AI guide inside the tour.
- Chat vendors sell AI answers but none of those pages showed 360 or map views.
- NuCampus360 combines the two for one campus. For Seattle, no virtual tour was found. SOURCED

Where competitors are stronger

- Scale and trust: YouVisit claims 700+ partners; Ocelot claims 500+ institutions (vendor claims).
- Integrations with CRM and student information systems.
- Analytics portals and multi-language support.

Implications

- Do not compete as a platform. Offer a lightweight pilot for one campus. PROPOSED
- Lead with the combination: see the space, ask the question. PROPOSED
- Offer admissions a view of the questions students ask. PROPOSED
- Ask for quotes from YouVisit and Concept3D so pricing claims can be compared. PROPOSED

Sources

- youvisit.com/virtual-tour-edu/ (undated)
- resources.concept3d.com/concept3d-virtual-tour-software; informedinfrastructure.com (Concept3D and Penn State); capterra.com/p/186475/Concept3D/reviews (most reviews 2019)

- ruffalonl.com/marketplace/campusreel/ (undated)
- mainstay.com/solutions/admissions/; yespress.io/lemnis.md (Mainstay joining Lemnis, March 2026, one secondary source)
- ocelot.ai/personas/recruiting-and-admissions/ (undated); educause.edu member press release, May 26, 2020

Limits

- Concept3D's own site did not load, so its analytics, AI and pricing are unverified.
- Customer counts and result figures are marketing claims.
- Northeastern's Boston map was not researched.

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Growth and go-to-market plan

How NuCampus360 could reach a first campus. Targets are proposals to test.

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> No usage data exists yet. Every number here is a proposal. TO CONFIRM

Customer and user

	WHO	WHAT THEY WANT
Buyer	Admissions or enrollment team at a campus	More enrolled students, fewer repeated questions, knowing what students ask
User	Incoming and prospective students	See the space, get answers fast, feel sure about the choice
Champion	A student ambassador or program coordinator	A better welcome experience

Offer for the pilot

- A tour of six core spaces with map, details and Ask AI. CONFIRMED for the prototype, PROPOSED for pilot terms
- A monthly summary of what students asked. PROPOSED
- A fixed-price trial for one intake cycle. PROPOSED

North Star metric

Tour completions that include at least one question asked: students who both explored and asked. PROPOSED

METRIC	WHY	PILOT TARGET
Tours started	Reach	500 in the first intake cycle
Locations viewed per tour	Engagement	At least 4
Questions asked per tour	Value of the AI guide	At least 2

METRIC	WHY	PILOT TARGET
Questions answered correctly or handed off safely	Trust	At least 90%
Inquiries from tour visitors	Business outcome	Track; compare with non-visitors
Student rating that the tour helped	Satisfaction	4 or higher out of 5

Go-to-market steps

STEP	ACTION	OUTPUT
1	Run 8 student sessions	Validated prototype
2	Trim to a 90-second intro and tidy 360 content	Pitch-ready demo
3	Meet the Seattle admissions team with the gap evidence from the competitive analysis	Pilot agreement
4	Add the tour link to the campus visit and virtual connect pages	Distribution
5	Share monthly question report; adjust content	Renewal case

Channels

CHANNEL	FIT	COST
Admissions emails and the Seattle Virtual Campus Connect sessions	High	Time
Student ambassadors sharing on social	Medium	Time
Link on the campus visit page	High	Time, needs approval
Admit-day events	Medium	Time

Experiments

#	HYPOTHESIS	TEST	SUCCESS
1	The tour gets more attention when sent right after admission	Send to two admit cohorts at different times	Higher start rate in one cohort
2	Questions from the tour reveal gaps in official materials	Review the top 20 questions	At least 5 content gaps found
3	Students who finish a tour ask fewer basic questions by email	Compare inquiry types	Fewer repeat questions

Risks

- Approval and privacy rules at a university take time.
- A competing vendor contract may already exist.
- Content needs upkeep each term.

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Budget

What the weekend cost and what a one-campus pilot would cost.

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> Prices come from public pages read on the dates shown. Usage and equipment numbers are my estimates. ESTIMATE

Hackathon weekend

ITEM	COST	BASIS
Figma	$0 on the free plan	ESTIMATE
AI chatbot during the event	Under $5 in usage	ESTIMATE
Photo and 360 capture	$0 using a phone	ESTIMATE
Labor	Volunteer time	CONFIRMED

Pricing inputs

ITEM	PRICE	SOURCE	BASIS
Claude Sonnet 5.5	$2 input, $10 output per million tokens	platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing, read 2026-10-15	SOURCED
Claude Haiku 5.5	$0.10 input, $0.50 output per million tokens (prompts up to 100K)	Same page	SOURCED
Commercial tour vendors	Not published	YouVisit, Concept3D, CampusReel pages	SOURCED none found

Pilot budget (one campus, one intake cycle)

ITEM	LOW	HIGH	NOTES	BASIS
360 camera purchase or rental	$0	$600	Phone panoramas versus a dedicated 360 camera	ESTIMATE
Hosting and domain	$60	$300	A static site plus a light backend	ESTIMATE
Chatbot usage (see table below)	$5	$250	Depends on visitors	ESTIMATE
Content writing and review by campus staff	$0	$0	Staff time, not charged here	ESTIMATE
Student session thank-yous	$120	$200	8 sessions at $15 to $25	ESTIMATE
Contingency (15%)			Add on top	PROPOSED

Chatbot cost per year

Assumes each visitor asks 5 questions, with about 1,500 input and 400 output tokens per question. ESTIMATE

VISITORS A YEAR	QUESTIONS	SONNET 5.5	HAIKU 5.5
1,000	5,000	$35.00	$1.75
5,000	25,000	$175.00	$8.75
20,000	100,000	$700.00	$35.00

Compared with a vendor

No vendor publishes a price. Ask for quotes before claiming savings. A lightweight pilot costs a few hundred dollars in cash; a vendor contract is likely far higher, but that is unverified. TO CONFIRM

Staffing view

PHASE	HOURS (ESTIMATE)
Validation sessions	30 to 40
Content and polish	40 to 60
Pitch and pilot setup	20 to 30
Pilot support	3 to 5 per week

> Hours are estimates. Labor is not priced. ESTIMATE

Open items

- Confirm the tools used for the hackathon chatbot and hosting. TO CONFIRM
- Confirm whether any 360 equipment was used. TO CONFIRM
- Collect vendor quotes. TO CONFIRM